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## Resonance

**A framework for cognitive resolution and diegetic game design.**

**Resonance is not a roleplaying game.**

It is a framework for designing roleplaying games where **resolution emerges from the fiction itself.**

Instead of asking:

*What is my character's percentage chance of success?*

Resonance asks:

**What, in this character and in this situation, actually matters right now?**

The player looks at the scene.

They identify what matters.

They bring the relevant elements of the fiction into the resolution.

Then the dice answer.

**No character-sheet calculations.**

**No search for the optimal modifier.**

**No mechanical interface between the player and the world.**

The rule becomes an extension of the player's perception.

## Resonance Core

**A generic engine for resolving uncertainty through fiction.**

Resonance Core is the generic resolution engine at the heart of Resonance.

It does not define a setting.

It does not define a genre.

It does not define how characters progress.

It does not tell you what magic looks like, how combat works, or what the world believes.

It provides something simpler:

**a way to turn what matters in a fictional situation into a resolution.**

This is where Resonance introduces one of its fundamental concepts: the **Bet**.

### 1. See the situation

The table establishes what is happening.

Not everything on the character sheet matters.

Not everything in the world matters.

The group determines what is relevant **now**.

This is the **Focus**.

### 3. Resolve

The relevant Bets determine the size of the resolution pool.

The dice are rolled.

But the dice do not decide everything on their own.

**The way the dice are interpreted depends on the game's Prisms.**

This is where Resonance becomes capable of adapting to radically different worlds.

### A resolution without an interface

Imagine a character trying to cross a dangerous battlefield.

A traditional system might ask:

**What is your movement score?**

**What is the difficulty?**

**Do you have a bonus?**

**What is your final modifier?**

Resonance asks something else:

**What matters here?**

Perhaps:

- the character knows how armies move;
- their brother is waiting on the other side;
- artillery is falling around them;
- they are carrying an injured companion;
- the enemy has spotted them.

Those elements can become Bets — if the player chooses to rely on them.

The player is not searching their character sheet for a number.

**They are looking at the world.**

They may hope that their knowledge of the battlefield will help.

They may fear that carrying an injured companion will slow them down.

They may decide that the enemy having spotted them is actually useful because it draws attention away from their companions.

The player is not calculating probabilities.

**They are making a judgment about what matters.**

That is the cognitive experience Resonance is designed to create.

### The Prism is the philosophy of the world made mechanical.

A good Prism answers questions such as:

**What does this universe consider true?**

**What does it consider possible?**

**What does it reward?**

**What does it punish?**

**What does it make dangerous?**

**How does the world's philosophy affect uncertainty?**

The result is a powerful inversion of traditional game design.

Instead of:

**Rules → fiction**

Resonance aims for:

**Fiction → rules**

The lore is no longer merely something players read.

**It becomes something they use.**

## **Resonance: Glorantha**

### **A concrete implementation.**

A framework becomes interesting when it can leave the page.

**Resonance: Glorantha** demonstrates what happens when Resonance is fully embedded in a specific fictional world.

Glorantha is not simply given a generic resolution system.

Its cosmology, religions and ways of understanding reality become part of the resolution itself.

The same underlying engine can therefore feel radically different depending on whether a character approaches reality through:

**Theism.**

**Animism.**

**Logic.**

**Mysticism.**

Or other ways of understanding the world.

This is the purpose of Resonance Prisms in practice:

**The system does not merely describe the world.**

**It makes the player experience the world through its own logic.**

### **Explore the implementation**

**Glorantha Perspectives** is the proof of concept and the detailed implementation of the framework.

Read the Glorantha Perspectives SRD →

## Designed for game designers

Resonance changes the role of the game designer.

You do not primarily have to design:

- hundreds of modifiers;
- exhaustive skill lists;
- rules for every possible situation;
- increasingly complex combat subsystems.

Instead, you design the things that make your world unique.

### **You create the fiction.**

Its:

**lore.**

**beliefs.**

**cultures.**

**relationships.**

**myths.**

**taboos.**

**metaphysics.**

### **You define what can matter.**

What can become a Bet?

What should never become one?

What does the game want players to notice?

### **You design the Prisms.**

How does this world respond to uncertainty?

How does its philosophy alter resolution?

What happens when a character acts against the fundamental logic of the world?

### **You define the boundaries.**

What is impossible?

What is forbidden?

What cannot simply be overcome by adding another argument?

These are the design decisions that give a Resonance game its identity.

## Resonance

One framework.

One Core.

Many Prisms.

Infinite worlds.

**Resonance** is a framework for cognitive resolution and diegetic game design.

**Resonance Core** provides the generic engine.

**Resonance Prisms** transform that engine into the logic of a particular world.

**Glorantha Perspectives** demonstrates one complete implementation.

The system does not define the world.

**The world defines the system.**

And when the mechanics become an extension of the fiction,

**the player no longer plays the rules.**

**They play the world.**